Government of India, for their part, have already given ample proof of their anxiety to respect Chinese sentiment, but they should not sacrifice their own interests in Tibet, or fail in their obligations to the Tibetan government, through fear that their interest in the Tibetan Question might be distasteful to the new Government of China,' Dayal wrote on 29 June 1950. [11] However, the response that was sent from New Delhi to Gangtok on 18 July 1950, which was to become the core of the Government's policy on Tibet, stated, 'The Government of India are of the opinion that the best hope of an amicable solution of the Tibet problem lies in firmly establishing friendship and understanding between India and China. This will enable us when the time comes, to safeguard our interests in Tibet and to discuss the status of Tibet, free from rancour and from past encumbrances.' [12]

This meant that India began to follow a dual strategy. On the one hand, in order to preserve its position on the boundary question, India publicly reiterated that all treaties between China and Great Britain would continue to remain in force, and voiced its support for Tibet's autonomy. On the other hand, it adopted a cautious attitude towards all Tibetan requests for assistance, whether it was their demand for arms and ammunition or for sponsorship of a resolution in the United Nations, for fear of upsetting the Chinese regime. The strategy did not permit India to raise its own concerns over Tibet with the Chinese through political or diplomatic channels, although there were voices within the Indian government that felt that after the PLA took over Tibet, it might be too late to negotiate these matters with China. This was the second lost opportunity to secure Indian interests in Tibet through negotiation, after India's failure to raise it as part of the process of diplomatic recognition. At that point in time, it appeared that the Government of India may not have wanted to give any